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AI glasses
for visually
impaired
wow Gitex

DUBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

Imagine navigating a busy street without sight — now imagine AI and autonomous driving technology guiding you every step of the way. At Gitex Global 2025 in Dubai, Romanian startup .lumen showcased just that, winning the Healthtech Pitch Competition and \$10,000 for its life-changing pedestrian guidance system for the visually impaired.

Founded by Cornel Amariei, .lumen's mission is deeply personal. Amariei was inspired by his family's experiences with disabilities, motivating him to create glasses for the visually impaired that mimic the guidance of a traditional guide dog. The result is a pair of smart glasses that empowers users to navigate safely and independently.

Utilising advanced technologies similar to those found in self-driving cars, such as artificial intelligence, computer vision, LiDAR, and infrared sensors, the glasses provide real-time navigation assistance. Through haptic feedback on the forehead, users receive subtle vibrations that guide their movements, acting like gentle nudges to avoid obstacles and find safe walking paths. The system could help the visually impaired replace the white cane and walk hands-free, without fear. The glasses also integrate with smartphones, allowing users to set destinations via Google Maps.

SEE ALSO P6

Trump warns Israel may resume strikes if Hamas fails truce terms

HAMAS HAS FREED ALL 20 LIVING CAPTIVES AND DELIVERED BODIES OF 8 OTHERS

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump has warned that Israel could return to military operations in Gaza if Hamas fails to uphold its commitments under the ceasefire deal that ended two years of war.

Speaking to CNN, Trump said Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu could send troops back into Gaza “as soon as I say the word” if Hamas did not fully comply with the agreement.

“What’s going on with Hamas — that’ll be straightened out quickly,” Trump said, describing the current truce as “fragile but holding.”

The president’s remarks came amid growing frustration in Israel over what officials call Hamas’ failure to hand over all hostages — both living and deceased — as stipulated in the truce.

72-hour deadline

Under Point 4 of Trump’s 20-point Middle East peace plan, all hostages were to be returned within 72 hours of Israel’s acceptance of the deal.

So far, Hamas has freed all 20 living captives and delivered the bodies of eight others, although one was found not to be an Israeli hostage.

Trump hailed the release of living hostages as “paramount,” while two senior US advisers clarified that Washington does not consider Hamas in violation of the deal.

They said mediators had assured the US that efforts were underway to locate the remain-



■ Palestinians receive donated food at a community kitchen in Deir Al Balah, central Gaza Strip, yesterday, amid the ongoing ceasefire between Israel and Hamas.

ing bodies, some of which may be buried under rubble from two years of bombardment.

Trump’s peace framework — backed by 59 nations at a summit in Egypt — envisions Gaza’s demilitarisation, amnesty for Hamas members who renounce violence, and a possible administrative role for the Palestinian National Authority (PNA) after reforms.

Yesterday, Netanyahu vowed to secure the return of all remaining hostages, saying “the fight is not over yet.”

Speaking at a state ceremony marking the second anniversary

of the October 7 Hamas attacks, he warned that anyone who harmed Israelis would “pay a very heavy price.”

Gaza reconstruction plan

Meanwhile, Palestinian Authority Prime Minister Mohammad Mustafa unveiled a \$65-billion, five-year reconstruction plan for Gaza, focused on housing, education, and governance.

He said the goal was to rebuild Gaza as “an open, connected and thriving part of the State of Palestine” and to restore political unity between Gaza and the West Bank.

“I would like to believe that 12 months from now, the Palestinian Authority will be fully operational in Gaza,” Mustafa said.

The plan builds on what was agreed at a summit of Arab countries in Cairo in March 2025, and Mustafa said that “police training programmes initiated with Egypt and Jordan are already underway.”

Despite deep divides over Gaza’s future governance, Trump voiced optimism. “Fifty-nine countries are part of this. We’ve never seen anything like it. Now it’s all happening,” he said.

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